

Walter S. Chang

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Education

Cornell University, Bowers College of Computing and Information Science, Ithaca NY
Master of Professional Studies – Data Science concentration | **GPA: 3.99**

May 2024

Cornell University, College of Agriculture and Life Sciences, Ithaca NY
Bachelor of Science in Information Science, Business Minor | **Magna Cum Laude, GPA: 3.88**

December 2023

Professional Experience

Data Scientist

San Francisco, CA

Extend

May 2025 – Present

- Deploy and optimize pricing and risk models to improve extended-warranty contribution margin across enterprise merchant partners, including Peloton, Oura Ring, Sonos, Michaels, and Advance Auto Parts.
- Generated \$600K+ in incremental net revenue from pricing and warranty-term optimizations, using behavioral economics to shape test design and Bayesian, frequentist, and quasi-experimental methods to evaluate impact.
- Partner with Engineering and GTM teams to prioritize revenue-impacting platform features and turn pricing test insights into concrete pricing changes, partner proposals, and deal economics that drive incremental revenue.

Founder & CEO

San Francisco, CA

RodSmith.app

January 2026 – Present

- Building RodSmith, a marketplace for custom fishing rods that helps anglers discover trusted rod builders and buy through the right transaction path: bespoke commission, made-to-order spec, or in-stock inventory.
- Validated demand through customer discovery with charter captains, anglers, and builders, shaping features such as rod load-testing visuals, builder trust signals, and warranty-backed purchasing.
- Rapidly prototyping with AI-assisted development across marketplace UX, buyer-builder workflows, and trust signaling.

Private Equity Analyst

San Francisco, CA

Carrick Capital Partners

June 2023 – August 2023 (Intern), August 2024 – May 2025

- Evaluated software investment opportunities through financial modeling, market research, and expert interviews.
- Covered cybersecurity and GRC, distilling complex technical concepts into investment-committee-ready takeaways.
- Built and deployed an internal web tool to rank investment prospects from market maps; used by analysts to prioritize sourcing and led to meetings with 3 companies at the RSA Conference. Reduced analysis time by ~80%.

Machine Learning Research - Prediction Error Analysis for Multiclass Transformer Models

Ithaca, NY

American Express

February 2024 – May 2024

- Implemented research-literature-driven label noise mitigation pipeline using HDBSCAN, Louvain, and LSTM models, reducing high-confidence misclassifications in automated support ticket routing.
- Led a team of 8 ML engineers, defining high-impact research direction in an ambiguous space & optimizing team execution.

Management Consulting Intern

New York, NY

PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC)

June 2022 – July 2022

- Developed a data-driven operational strategy for client CareerVillage to improve career-advice matching efficiency between student inquiries and professional responses.
- Led a team to 2nd place out of 70+ teams in a firmwide consulting case competition; presented to a Partner panel.

Projects and Extracurricular Experience

Beta Analysis of Large-Cap Banks During the 2008 Financial Crisis – Risk Modeling Project

Ithaca, NY

STSCI 5610 – Data Science in Risk Modeling

April 2024

- Applied CAPM in R to estimate alpha and beta, evaluating stock volatility and market-relative performance.
- Conducted statistical testing (t-tests, p-values) to assess CAPM validity during the 2008 financial crisis.

BikeBright Survey Analysis – Applied Statistics Project

Ithaca, NY

AEM 3100 – Business Statistics

April 2022

- Worked with startup BikeBright to optimize their product roadmap for prototyping smart cycling apparel.
- Conducted Chi-Square analysis to determine the relationship between gender, cycling level, and product preference.
- Designed and administered targeted surveys to gather data aligned with our client's key business objectives.

Specialized Skills

Technical: SQL, Python, Snowflake, dbt, Git & GitHub, Statistical Testing, AI-assisted Development, Financial Analysis